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Cedar Bend Carriers Driver Pay Policy

SAMPLE. Cedar Bend Carriers is a fictitious carrier based in Marion, Illinois, created for a software demonstration. Every name, amount and rule in this document is invented.

1. Purpose and scope

1.1 This policy explains how Cedar Bend Carriers pays its company drivers and its leased owner-operators, what it deducts from a settlement, and how a driver can question a settlement. It takes effect on December 6, 2026 and replaces every earlier pay letter.

1.2 Where a driver's signed lease or offer letter sets a different rate for that driver, the signed document wins for that rate only. Everything else in this policy still applies.

2. Pay week and pay day

2.1 The pay week runs from 12:00 a.m. Sunday through 11:59 p.m. Saturday, Central time. All dates and times in this policy and on settlement statements are Central time.

2.2 Settlements are paid by direct deposit on the Thursday after the pay week closes. A load counts in the pay week in which it is delivered with a signed bill of lading.

3. How drivers are paid

3.1 Company drivers on long-haul lanes are paid $0.58 per loaded mile. Company drivers on regional routes are paid a flat $185 per load.

3.2 Leased owner-operators are paid 70 percent of the linehaul, fuel surcharge and accessorial charges on each load they haul.

3.3 Empty miles driven under dispatch are paid to per-mile drivers at 80 percent of the loaded rate. Miles are measured from the practical route, not the odometer.

4. Accessorial pay and reimbursements

4.1 When a customer pays a detention, layover or extra-stop charge on a load, the driver who hauled the load receives 60 percent of that charge on the settlement for the week the customer is billed.

4.2 Lumper fees and tolls paid by the driver are reimbursed at cost when the receipt is turned in with the trip paperwork. Reimbursements are not shared and are not counted as pay.

5. Occupational accident insurance

5.1 Every driver, company or leased, is covered under the carrier's occupational accident policy. The carrier charges $11.00 per day, billed as $77.00 per week, for each day the driver is under a dispatched load.

5.2 A driver who is not under a load for a full pay week is not charged for that week.

6. Net pay protection

6.1 No deduction of any kind may take a driver's weekly net pay under $275. When deductions would go below that amount, the carrier holds back the rest and carries it to the next settlement.

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6.2 The carrier does not keep an escrow account for any driver.

7. Advances

7.1 A driver may ask for an advance against pay already earned and not yet paid. Each advance carries a fee of $3 to $5 depending on the card it is loaded to.

7.2 An advance may not be less than $50. A driver may not owe more than $500 in advances at one time, and no single advance may be more than 40 percent of the driver's earned and unpaid pay.

7.3 Advances and their fees are recovered from the driver's settlements, with no cap on the amount taken back from one settlement, until repaid.

8. Detention billing to customers

8.1 Unless a customer's contract says otherwise, the carrier allows 90 minutes free at each pickup and each delivery, then bills detention at $55 per hour in 15-minute increments.

8.2 Detention is measured from the arrival and departure times written on the bill of lading. Drivers record both times at every stop; a stop missing either time cannot be billed.

9. Fuel and company cards

9.1 Drivers may buy fuel with a carrier fuel card. Fuel an owner-operator buys on a carrier card is deducted from that owner-operator's next settlement at the price paid.

9.2 A fuel card is for the assigned truck only, on dispatched trips. A purchase off the planned route or on a day the truck is not under a load is reviewed before it is allowed or deducted.

10. Questions, corrections and changes

10.1 A driver who believes a settlement is wrong should tell the payroll office in writing within 30 days of the pay date. The carrier reviews every question and corrects a confirmed error on the next settlement.

10.2 The carrier may change this policy with written notice before the pay week in which the change takes effect. A change never applies to a pay week that has already begun.

Fictitious carrier created for a software demonstration. Not a real company or policy.